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K4. Living Costs

Accommodation

For most international students, accommodation is the biggest expense they will incur while studying in France. The cost of rent will vary according to where students choose to live and the type of accommodation they choose. Generally, rent in France is higher than the international average by about 200–300/EUR per month. Rent in Paris and larger cities will be higher than in smaller cities and rural areas.

StudyPortals lists the following accommodation price ranges for international students in France in 2020:

- **Student halls of residence** – on average, 200 EUR/month. Paris is the exception, at 400 EUR/month. Around 13% of international students live in student residences. It's one of the most popular accommodation options among students, but the demand is much higher than the supply.
- **Rent/share an apartment** – between 400 and 700 EUR/month (800 EUR/month in Paris), while in smaller French cities you can rent a small apartment for about 300 EUR/month.
- If you live with your partner and/or child(ren), the price for rent will range from 700 to 1,000 EUR/month, and you could pay higher if you choose an apartment in the city centre. The utility bills (electricity, water, the internet) would be another 200 EUR/month.
- **Host family** – you can find rates that are only 200 EUR/month to about 800 EUR/month in Paris.

International students also have access to **VISALE** which is a programme that acts as a guarantor. A guarantor is someone who promises to cover

your rent costs if you can no longer do it. However, the VISALE programme only helps international students who rent an apartment/room in a university residence (student hall).

In some cases, students will have to pay utility costs which average around 30 EUR/month for electricity.

Tuition

Study.EU provides the following information:

If you are a citizen or already a permanent resident of a country within the EEA:

- 170 euros per year for bachelor's (*Licence*) programmes
- 243 euros per year for master's programmes
- 601 euros per year in Engineering courses in at certain institutions
- 380 euros per year for doctorate (PhD) programmes

If you are a non-EU international student:

- 2,770 euros per year for bachelor's (*Licence*) programmes,
- 3,770 euros per year for master's programmes,
- 380 euros per year for doctorate (PhD) programmes – the same amount as for Europeans.

Note that the values above refer only to public universities; the cost of tuition at private universities can be higher. They generally range from 3,000 to 20,000 euros per year.

Food

A lunch meal can cost from 10–20 EUR and dinner can average 15–30 EUR. Students should budget at least 200–300 EUR/month for meals.

Average prices include:

Baguette 1 EUR

Sandwich 3–6 EUR

Coffee 2.62 EUR

Beer 5 EUR

Wine 4–7 EUR

Social and other living expenses

Other costs to consider include:

- **Mobile phone costs:** Prepaid phone cards start from 3.90 EUR/per month or a plan can run from 2–30 EUR a month, depending on the services a student chooses.
- **Internet:** Some accommodations will include internet in the rent costs, but to purchase the services, the costs can range from 10–45 EUR/month, again, depending on the level of service a student chooses.
- **Cinema ticket:** 8–10 EUR
- **Haircut:** 15–35 EUR
- **Laundry:** One load of wash in a laundromat is approximately 4–5 EUR

Please Note: As in any region, living costs will change slightly from year to year in France. Some typical living costs are covered here but these will change frequently.

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